

Let's applaud...

They may not have made the top 100—but these TOP PEOPLE made a top contribution to AMERICAN AND CANADIAN HISTORY.

Benjamin Franklin (1706–1790)

Franklin first became known as a printer in Philadelphia, but he was also a civic leader, a writer, a scientist, an inventor, and one of the Founding Fathers of the American Revolution.

Thomas Jefferson (1743–1826)

Jefferson was the primary author of the Declaration of Independence in 1776. He was later Ambassador to France and Secretary of State. As the third president of the United States from 1801 to 1808, he approved the Louisiana Purchase.

Noah Webster (1758–1843)

Webster was the author of *An American Dictionary of the English Language*, first published in 1828. He was also an educational reformer dedicated to the idea that American children should learn from American books.

Eli Whitney (1765–1825)

Whitney was an inventor who developed the cotton gin, which revolutionized the way cotton was prepared for market. He also promoted the use of interchangeable parts in manufacturing, which made for more reliable products.

Sacajawea (c.1788–1812)

A young Native American woman who became an interpreter and guide for the Lewis and Clark Expedition in 1804, Sacajawea accompanied the explorers from present-day North Dakota to the Pacific Northwest and back again.

Abraham Lincoln (1809–1865)

As President of the United States, Lincoln led the Union during the greatest crisis in the country's history, the Civil War. He was assassinated on April 15, 1865, six days after the war ended.

Frederick Douglass (1818–1895)

Born into slavery, Douglass escaped as a young man after secretly learning to read and write. He became an inspirational writer and speaker, challenging the established views of racism and helping to see them changed.

Walt Whitman (1819–1892)

A writer who volunteered as a nurse during the Civil War, Whitman's masterpiece was *Leaves of Grass*, which contained only 12 poems when first published in 1855. He added hundreds more in later editions over his lifetime.

Sir Sandford Fleming (1827–1915)

Fleming was an engineer and inventor from Scotland who moved to Canada at age 17. He was inspired to propose worldwide time zones after missing a train in 1876 that had incorrectly posted the departure time.

Louisa May Alcott (1832–1888)

The author of many books, notably *Little Women*, Alcott chronicled the adventures of the four March girls during the Civil War. She based much of her writing on the experiences of herself and her family.

Andrew Carnegie (1835–1919)

After immigrating from Scotland as a child, Carnegie made a great fortune in the emerging steel industry. He used his wealth to create many charitable organizations, including more than 1,600 public libraries across the United States.

Mark Twain (1835–1910)

Samuel Langorne Clemens was better known by his pen name, Mark Twain. The prolific writer and humorist was best known for *The Adventures of Tom Sawyer* and *Adventures of Huckleberry Finn*.



The original rules of basketball did not include three-point shots, dribbling, or dunking the ball



Mary Cassatt (1844–1926)

One of the few women artists of the 19th century, Cassatt worked as both a painter and printmaker. She spent much of her adult life in France where she was friends with many of the Impressionists.

James Naismith (1861–1939)

Naismith invented the game of basketball in 1891, while working as a physical education teacher in Springfield, MA. Points were scored by throwing a ball into a peach basket nailed high on the wall.